sat quietly in their seats for a half hour listening to the latest episode.

Radio was magic. It was theater of the mind. It forced you to use your imagination. You'd sit in your living room and be transported to glamorous locales around the world, and eavesdrop on stories of romance and adventure brought to life by a few actors and vivid sound effects transmitted over the radio waves—a squeaking door or a horse galloping across the desert. It's sad that we've now had several generations who've never had a chance to use their imagination in the way we did.

Radio had created a new profession—the sports announcer—as radio's influence grew in America. Broadcasting play-by-play reports of football games, people like Graham McNamee and Ted Husing had become as famous as some Hollywood stars and often they were more famous than the athletes they reported on.

At Eureka, I'd listened to their broadcasts religiously and sometimes, when we were lounging around the TKE house, I'd pick up a broomstick, pretend it was a microphone, and do a mock locker-room interview with one of my fraternity brothers to get some laughs.

After my graduation in June 1932, I went back to Lowell Park for another summer so I could save some money and begin paying back my debt for overdue tuition. There was a summer hotel at the park called The Lodge that attracted well-off families, mostly from Chicago, who returned year after year to spend their vacations in the country. Over the years I'd taught the children of many of the families how to swim and their fathers had often come up to me and said they'd help me get a job after I'd gotten my college diploma. The Depression had changed all that: A lot of people didn't take summer vacations in the summer of 1932 and among those who did, few were in a position to help me get a job.